

4 Email on the go

The Gmail application in Android is very closely hooked to the Android OS. On the surface, it's just another web-based email client. But it uses a relatively unique method of displaying messages, grouping them by threads, so that as you exchange email, they take up only one line in your inbox.

4.1 Reading Email

Reading email is quick and easy. Whenever you receive a new email, you get a nice little notification on the status bar to let you know.

Now, just like every other time you get a status bar notification in the upper left, you can tap the status bar and drag it down the screen to see your notifications. Note that, you can just tap Clear notifications to get rid of all the notifications, or you can tap the notification in question to pull up—well, whatever the notification is for. In the case of email, you just tap New email. Because Gmail stores email as conversations, you would find several unread conversations. If it's only one email, tapping the New email notification loads that specific email. If you have multiple unread conversations, you instead end up in your Inbox.

If you want to read all the mail in your Inbox that isn't new, just open the Application tab and tap on Gmail.

You can use the trackball or your finger to scroll through the list. If a conversation has an unread message, it's bold in the list, with a white background. Tap an email to open it. If it's a completely read conversation, you see the most recent message, along with a link to tap to see all the messages. If the conversation contains unread messages, they are all open for you to read.

If you receive a message with an attachment, you can preview most



You'll receive alerts on the top left of the screen